"I asked them to keep the chair for that purpose alone. Anyway, you need one for that too, no?"

I didn't know what to say. I hurried home to convey this news to Pedanna. But gradually, my steps slowed to an ordinary **gait**.

About The Author

Rajanarayanan, popularly known by Tamil initials as Ki. Ra., is a Tamil folklorist and a prolific author. The short story 'The chair' is written in 1969 and its original title is 'Naarkaali' The novels Gopalla Grammam and its sequel Gopallapurathu Makkal are among his most acclaimed; he won the Sahitya Akademi award for the latter in 1991. As a folklorist, Ki. Ra. spent decades collecting folktales from the karisal kaadu and publishing them in popular magazines. In 2007, the Thanjavur based publishing house Annam compiled these folktales into a 944-page book, the Nattuppura Kadhai Kalanjiyam (Collection of Country Tales). As of 2009, he has published around 30 books. A selection of these were translated into English by Pritham K. Chakravarthy and published in 2009 as Where Are You Going, You Monkeys? – Folktales from Tamil Nadu.

Glossary

Portly	-	stocky
Spluttered	-	cackled ,make a series of short sounds.
Impudent	-	disrespectful
Expounded	-	explained
Languorously	-	lethargically.
Hordes	-	crowd, masses
Exasperatedly	-	annoyingly
Splendour	-	magnificence
Paraphernalia	-	things,stuffs
Bereavement	-	mourning, grief
Gait	-	pace

1. Answer the following questions in one or two sentences each based on your understanding of the story.

a) What was put on the family agenda?

b) Who visited the family?

c) Describe the stool that the narrator's family had.

d) What was Pedanna's suggestion to their father?

e) What was offered to Maamanaar by their mother?

f) Why were the two chairs compared to Rama-Lakshmana?

g) When did the children shy away from the chair?

h) How did Maamanaar handle the chair at home?

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